resources are available naturally to the states in the form of soil and its products, water and its products and minerals. These in turn helps the states to develop industrially, economically and also militarily. However, huge possession of resources does not add up to one's strength, but the utilization of the particular product is important. The possession of oil, uranium and atomic energy has been utilized by various states to their advantage, which have contributed to the strengthening of their position in international arena. Thus, huge quantities of oil have helped the West Asian and Gulf countries to embark on the policy of oil diplomacy. The most noteworthy incident shaking the international economy, was the oil embargo by the OPEC countries in 1973. Self-sufficiency in food, mineral and energy resources has also helped the United States and Russian foreign policy choices.

***Economic Development:*** The economic performance of a state in terms of GNP per capita provides the key to understand the state's ability to utilize its natural and human resources which adds up to its national power and determines its policy choices and menu. The United States, by far the largest economy recording a highest Gross National Product (GNP), is always able to secure its objectives vis-à-vis underdeveloped and developing states and also to some extent in relation to certain developed states too such as Britain and France. The levels of high economic development provide leverage to the countries to flex their muscles in relation to economically weak countries. However, the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) has forwarded a different view of development. The GNP is not always an indicator of the well-being of the masses. Therefore, UNDP has introduced the Human Development Index (HDI) to calculate economic development of a state. This includes three basic components of human development—longevity, knowledge and standard of living. But it had also been revealed that those countries ranking high in HDI group have also high GNP per capita. Therefore, whether it is HDI or GNP measure of economic development, it is the developed countries who are in an advantageous position and are able to call the shots in international relations. Therefore, economic development is a crucial factor as far as national power is concerned. The level of economic development also determines the